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Sanghyun Han

Department of Agribusiness and Applied Economics
North Dakota State University, Fargo, ND 58108
sanghyun.han.1@ndsu.edu · sanghyunhanecon.github.io

Academic Positions

Research Assistant Professor, Department of Agribusiness and Applied Economics, North Dakota State University — August 2025–present
Affiliate, Center for Agricultural Policy and Trade Studies

Education

Boston College — August 2025
Ph.D. in Economics
Dissertation Title: "Essays on International Trade"
Dissertation Committee: James E. Anderson (Chair), Hideo Konishi, and Farid Farrokhi

Boston College — 2020
M.S. in Economics

The University of Sydney — 2015
B.A. in Economics, First Class Honours

Research Interests

International Trade, Agricultural Economics, Spatial Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Job Market Paper

Cooperation, Commitments, and the Value of the World Trading System [SSRN]

This paper asks how changes in the trading environment affect the welfare value of the world trading system. It extends a revealed-preference framework to represent the system as two restraints, cooperation in governments' objectives and commitments that cap tariffs at WTO bindings and preferential ceilings. In the calibrated 2017 tradable economy, positive tariffs below these ceilings imply that governments count a dollar of foreign real income as about half a dollar at home. Together, the two restraints raise world real income by about 0.81 percent relative to noncooperation. The 2018 to 2019 tariff conflict between the United States and China lowers world real income but raises the aggregate value of the remaining system by 9.5 percent. At the margin, the conflict makes raising tariffs on third-country imports less costly for both countries. The system preserves most of third countries' gains from diverted trade, mainly through commitments that limit tariff adjustment. Projected climate change instead leaves the system's aggregate value nearly unchanged, since large agricultural productivity changes affect a small share of modeled trade and manufacturing changes are small. The system therefore provides little additional mitigation of the projected income losses.

Working Papers

"The Mississippi River and Agricultural Trade: A Spatial Equilibrium Approach" [SSRN]
Presented at AAEA 2026

"Trade, Regulation, and the Global Diffusion of Genetically Modified Crops" (with S. Steinbach, C. Zurita, and F. Barbosa)
Presented at AAEA 2026 and IATRC 2025

"Vertical Tariff Incidence Along the Supply Chain: Evidence from the US Beef Sector, 2025–2026" (with Y. Lwin, S. Steinbach, C. Zurita, and S. Arita)
Revise and resubmit, *Agricultural Economics*

"Agricultural Biotechnology as Adaptation to Climate Change" (with S. Steinbach)

Work in Progress

"Tariff-Rate Quotas in Quantitative Trade Models"

"The Political Economy of GM Crop Approvals: A Machine Learning Approach" (with S. Steinbach)

Other Publications

"Public Concerns, Farm-Level Performance, and the GM Crop Debate" (with F. Barbosa, C. Zurita, and S. Steinbach)
Choices, 41(3), 2026 [DOI]

Research Support

USDA NIFA Agriculture and Food Research Initiative, Economics, Markets, and Trade — 2024–2028

"Partnership: Evaluating the Economic Consequences of Genetically Modified Organism Regulations on International Trade, Food Security, and Welfare." Project Director: S. Steinbach. Role: Project researcher. Supports research on biotechnology and trade.

Honors and Fellowships

Young Professional Travel Grant, International Agricultural Trade Research Consortium — 2025

Academic Merit Prize, The University of Sydney — 2013

Summer Research Assistantship, The University of Sydney — 2012

Presentations

2026 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting, Kansas City
2025 International Agricultural Trade Research Consortium (IATRC) Annual Meeting, Washington, DC
2024 Boston College International Trade Seminar, Boston, MA

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Microeconomic Theory (undergraduate, three semesters), Boston College — 2023–2024

Teaching Assistant, Industrial Organization (graduate), Econometric Methods (undergraduate), and Principles of Economics (undergraduate), Boston College

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics labs (undergraduate, Stata), The University of Sydney

Skills

Programming	MATLAB, Stata
Languages	English, Korean

Personal Information

Citizenship	Korea, Republic of

References

Professor James E. Anderson
William B. Neenan, S.J.
Millennium Professor
Department of Economics
Boston College
Maloney Hall
140 Commonwealth Avenue
Chestnut Hill, MA 02467
james.anderson.1@bc.edu

Professor Farid Farrokhi
Department of Economics
Boston College
Maloney Hall
140 Commonwealth Avenue
Chestnut Hill, MA 02467
farid.farrokhi@bc.edu

Professor Sandro Steinbach
Farmers Union Endowed Professor
Director, Center for Agricultural Policy and Trade Studies
Department of Agribusiness and Applied Economics
North Dakota State University
Richard H. Barry Hall
Fargo, ND 58108
sandro.steinbach@ndsu.edu